

Bennett, Coleman & Co. Limited.	HR Policies & Procedures
Effective: August 1, 2024	Policy No:
Title: Personal Investments in Unlisted Business Entities	Version: 1.0
Department: Human Resources	Total Pages: 3

1. Objective:

Employees while making Personal Investments (purchase, sale or holding) in unlisted Business Entities (Startups or Unlisted Companies or Angel/Venture Capital Funds) may at times find themselves in scenarios of possible conflicts of interest with the Company or their work responsibilities. The purpose of this policy is to establish clear guidelines for employees to prevent the misuse of sensitive information, avoid any conflicts of interest, avoid distraction from their work responsibilities and ensure compliance with any regulatory requirements.

This policy lays down guidelines and procedures which will govern such personal investments. By doing so, the organization aims to maintain transparency, accountability, and protect its reputation and assets.

This policy is to be read in conjunction with relevant sections on personal investments in the Appointment letter and Code of Conduct & Ethics.

2. Applicability:

This policy will be applicable to the following:

1. EC & Functional Directors (and equivalent Editorial grades)
2. All Employees, Full-time consultants & Journalists (with external interfacing roles in functions like Brand Capital/Response/OMS etc. and in ET/ TOI/MT/NBT business desk respectively)

In context of this policy, personal investments of “Employees / Full-time Consultants” of the Company will also include, the personal investments of their immediate family (parents, spouse, children), associates or any family trusts or other investment vehicle if the relevant investment is established to have been influenced by the employee concerned.

3. Policy Guidelines:

The following policy guidelines must be followed by employees while contemplating any personal investment.

3.1 Investment Guidelines to Prevent Conflict of Interest:

1. Brand Capital or Response employees who have dealt with or are dealing with an entity as a client, should refrain from investing in such entities. Should they choose to proceed with such an investment, it may only be done with prior approval (defined in this Policy under **Investment Approval**). Response and other market facing executives should also

transparently disclose to their reporting managers any conflicts of interest while working on advertisement deals. Editorial employees or Journalists must declare, as per the protocols in place (defined in this Policy under **Investment Declaration**), their dealings in unlisted Business Entities, if they are working /worked on any story/article on the said entity in the case of Journalists.

2. Confidential/sensitive information available to the Company, Company resources and team members should not be used to evaluate and invest in unlisted Business Entities.
3. Investment activities should not distract employees from prioritizing their work and performing their responsibilities effectively and to their full potential. All investment related efforts must be undertaken after office hours or on weekly off days. Investee entities must be managed on a passive basis i.e. without any active involvement.

3.2 Guidelines on Investment:

1. Number of Investments in unlisted Business Entities should not exceed 4 during the financial year.
2. Investments in unlisted Business Entities should not exceed 1% of the total capital raised by the investee entity.
3. Employees should not be engaged as a consultant nor hold any position or title in the investee entity, including a Directorship on its Board.

3.3 Investment Eligibility:

Employees must make sure that there are no conflicts of interest when investing in any unlisted Business Entities. In addition, the following entities cannot be invested in by our employees

1. An entity that is an existing client of Brand Capital. However, this will exclude
 - unlisted business entities where an employee already has an existing investment, which is prior to exploration / initiation of discussions of a deal by Brand Capital
2. An entity that is currently under evaluation by Investment Committee (IC)
3. An entity that had been evaluated by IC in the previous 6 months from the date of the proposed investment by the employees.

In the above scenarios, the Company's decision for such requests will be final and binding.

4. Investment Process

The following steps are to be followed by employees while making an investment in an unlisted Business Entity

4.1 Approval for Sale or Purchase:

- 4.1.1 All EC Members, Functional Directors & Vice Presidents (and equivalent Editorial grades) should disclose and obtain prior approval from CEO.
- 4.1.2 All other employees covered under this policy should disclose and obtain prior approval from Brand Capital Functional Head.

Employees shall not permit their names to be used, either directly or indirectly, by such investee Business Entities without prior approval as stated above.

4.2 Investment declaration: All Employees covered under this policy should declare to their Functional Head / Executive Editor their total shares holdings in unlisted Business Entities as per the protocols in place in scenarios of possible conflicts of interest.

In addition, the following must declare their personal Investments in unlisted Business Entities on Timescape >> Compliance >> Equity Investment / Trading Disclosure on a quarterly basis:

- EC & Functional Directors (and equivalent Editorial grades)
- All employees & Full-Time Consultants in
 - Brand Capital
 - The Economic Times (at level of Principal/ Manager & above)
 - Business desks of TOI, MT & NBT
 - Any other employees who may be identified by the Company

5. Non-adherence of Policy: In cases where it is found that the policy has not been adhered to / has been violated, the Company may undertake the following actions in addition to any other actions that it may need to take to protect its interests and reputation:

1. Issue a warning
2. Monetary penalty in proportion to the unfair gains earned
3. Debar employee from making any future investments in unlisted Business Entities for a limited period of time.
4. Terminate the employee as violation of Code of Conduct.

6. Interpretation:

Any matter not specifically covered under the above guidelines shall be referred to MAS & Human Resources. The interpretation of this policy rests exclusively with the Company and the decision of the Company shall be final and binding on all.